

When you want to communicate clearly, it can be helpful to avoid repetition. One way to do this is to drop any unnecessary words.

⚙️ **New language** Ellipsis

Aa **Vocabulary** Entertainment

🧩 **New skill** Leaving out unnecessary words

62.1 KEY LANGUAGE ELLIPSIS

If the meaning of a sentence is clear from the surrounding text, you can use ellipsis (leaving out certain words) to avoid repetition. This is most common after "and," "but," and "or." Sometimes you can drop a repeated verb in a different form.

He bought tickets, **but** [he] didn't go.

Often a repeated **subject** is dropped after "and," "but," and "or."



She loved the original **and** [she loved] the sequel.

If the meaning remains clear, a repeated **subject and verb** can be dropped.



I'm happy to go out **or** [I'm happy to] stay home.

Generally, you can omit words **that** have already been mentioned and do not require repetition.



62.2 FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE REPEATED WORDS THAT HAVE BEEN DROPPED

I told him I would book the tickets, but I haven't [booked the tickets] yet.

- ① They wanted to see the band perform live, but now they can't [_____].
- ② He was fantastic in the television series and [_____] the movie adaptation.
- ③ If you want to see a movie we could go to the multiplex or [_____] the art house.
- ④ The reviews said that the acting was bad and [_____] the soundtrack was terrible.
- ⑤ The two lead actors did all the stunts and [_____] sang all the songs themselves.
- ⑥ I am quitting my job this week. I will call you later to explain why [_____].

